

EXPLORE.....

**The newsletter of the
Friends of Telford Town Park**



Summer 2014

Promoting . Conserving . Protecting
www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

NEW CHAIR FOR THE FRIENDS



At the Annual General Meeting on Wednesday 9 April John Trubshaw was elected as the new chair for the Friends of Telford Town Park. John has been an active member of the Friends for several years and takes over from Chris Pettman, the longest serving chairman in the eleven year history of the group. Chris will remain an active volunteer.

Upon his appointment John said: "I am honoured to take on this role as chair of the Friends of Telford Town Park and to continue the great work done by the previous incumbents over the past 11 years. My vision for the future is to see more young people involved in activities in the park. Within the FOTTP, the establishment of a 'Junior Rangers' section to swell the ranks and train the next generation of conservation volunteers is essential for the future of the park and is a priority."

"I would like to see the already firmly established relationship between the Friends and the Town Park Management Team further strengthened as we join forces to continue the good work of Catherine Penney and the Parks for People project over the past few years. It would be wonderful to continue the very popular programme of free drop in events and other activities based at the Visitor Centre and to create new activities."

"For these aims to be achieved, we will of course need more volunteers and financing and I look forward to working with the officers of the Executive Committee and wider Friends volunteers to raise our profile both publicly and commercially. Together I am sure that we can encourage the good folk of Telford and beyond to venture past the wonderful play areas and into the park at large. How great it would be to see families enjoying a picnic in any one of the open spaces within the park and appreciating the wonders of nature around them that it is our purpose to conserve and protect."

**John Trubshaw
Chair, Friends of Telford Town Park.**

To contact John email: [REDACTED]

TELFORD TOWN PARK



Above: Grange Pool, Stirchley

Below: Bronze Horse in Chelsea Gardens



Left: Part of the beautiful Maxell Cherry Gardens



Right: Stirchley Chimney at dusk

We are very grateful to Great Dawley Town Council for assisting the Friends with the cost of producing this newsletter and also to Hollinswood & Randlay Parish Council, Stirchley and Brookside Parish Council, Madeley Town Council, Lawley & Overdale Parish Council and the Southwater Event Group for their ongoing support of the Friends of Telford Town Park. Thank you all very much.

NEW FRIENDS' SENSORY GARDEN



Some of the planting in the, as yet, unfinished Sensory Garden



The new Friends' Sensory Garden located within the Park's Chelsea Gardens is now nearing completion with the official opening being planned for mid September.

The garden will feature raised beds, a herb bed, seating, sculptures, water features and a specially created 'singing ringing tree' designed by sculptor David Mayne. The 'wind chime' leaves on the tree have been designed during a workshop with the artist by children from Southall School, Telford.

Chris Pettman, member of the Friends' Gardening Group said: "The new garden will be a secluded and peaceful haven to refresh the senses. We have loved working on it for the past 18 months and hope that many people will come along and enjoy it for many years to come".

The Sensory Garden which measures 24m x 12m has been designed and created by the Friends' Gardening Group in conjunction with professional landscape artist Teresa Rham of Groundesigns and has been funded by the Town Park and the Parks for People Lottery fund.

NEW FRIENDS' SENSORY GARDEN

Donations have also been gratefully received from local and other companies which included plants, bricks and topsoil as well as cash.

Official opening

Saturday 13 September

12.30 - 2pm

The Sensory Garden will be open to the public following the official opening by the Mayor of the borough of Telford & Wrekin on Saturday 13th September at 1pm. Everyone is invited to come along and join in the celebrations, take a tour of the garden with the Gardening Group and enjoy some fun activities and entertainment. For further details visit: www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org



Some initial construction work



Grasses and herb beds



Pathways still to be surfaced for smooth access

SANTA FUN RUN 2014



Just a few of last years happy runners, walkers and joggers!

The Friends are delighted to announce that this year's annual Santa Fun Run will be taking place on Sunday 7 December. This will be the eighth year for the event.

Raising funds for both the RNIB and Guide Dogs UK, the Santa Fun Run is an established festive fun event for people of all ages and abilities. Runners, joggers, walkers, toddlers in pushchairs and dogs on leads are all welcome to join in.

Last year's event was the biggest ever attracting over 200 participants and raising £2,000 for our charities and to date the event has raised more than £14,000.

This year we want to do even better and we would like as many people as possible to come and join in the fun. Online registration will be available from the beginning of August. Alternatively you can pick up a registration form from the Park Visitor Centre or visit us on our stand at some of the local community events taking place in Telford in July and August. For further details visit our web site: www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org.

A £5 registration fee applies for everyone over the age of 16. Under 16 free.

NEWS ROUND UP

Volunteering Opportunities

There's always plenty of work to be done in the Park and we are always delighted to welcome new volunteers. Whether you want to spend just a few hours now and again or would like to be a regular volunteer, whatever time you can spare would be appreciated and you may well enjoy it too!

Drop in Gardening Group (Chelsea Gardens incl. New Sensory Garden)

Every first and third Wednesday of the month 10am - 1pm. General garden maintenance and an opportunity to learn about plants and gain new skills. All tools and gloves provided. Meet at the Visitor Centre.

Plant Sales. Every first and third Wednesday of each month, 10am to 1pm

An opportunity to purchase plants that we grow in the Chelsea Gardens and Sensory Garden. Prices from £1. All monies raised supports our work in the gardens.

View from the air.

We are all familiar with the beauty of our Town Park from ground level but we rarely get the opportunity to see it from above. Thanks to our friends in the Telford Park Run we can now see just how lovely it looked from the air in the early June sunshine - really awesome. The video taken from one of the new radio controlled mini helicopters, shows some fascinating views of the Park - including a peek over the barriers to the new Southwater lake.

Visit: www.friendsoftelfrodtownpark.org to view.



*The Visitor Centre and
childrens playground
from the air*

Where to find the Friends this summer.

In order to promote the work that we do and to recruit new volunteers, we regularly have a stand at local community events. Why not come and find us and find out what we do. Visit us at Malinslee Day, Saturday 26 July, Parks for People Celebration Day, Thursday 31 July, T Party in the Park, Saturday 2 August (joint stand with the Telford Green Spaces Partnership) and at the official opening event for the new Sensory Garden on Saturday 13 September, 12.30 - 2.30pm.

WHAT'S ON IN THE PARK

There's always lots going on in the Park for people of all ages. With the summer holidays coming up there's plenty for children and families and most of it is free of charge.

- Playground including trim trail for all ages
 - Water play area
 - Fishing in several lakes. Day tickets available*
 - NEW heritage and nature trails - maps available
 - NEW adventure 12 hole golf course*
 - NEW Aerial rope course and zip wire*
 - NEW regular guided walk programme starting from April
 - NEW Walking for Health walks every second Sunday of the month at 2pm
- * denotes fees payable - payment for activities and maps available from the Visitor Centre*



See below

SUMMER HOLIDAY ACTIVITIES FOR CHILDREN

Suitable for age 5+ and free of charge. Children must be accompanied by an adult. Where booking is stated as required please call 01952 - 382340 or email: telfordtownpark@telford.gov.uk

Thursday 31 July, Parks for People Celebration Day. Official launch of the new nature and heritage trails in the Park. Heritage/Archaeology Tour, 10am - 12noon.
Nature Trail walk, 2 - 4pm plus other activities around the Visitor Centre. Booking required for the tour and walk.

Saturday 2 August, T-Party Community Fun Day, 11am - 4pm. Visit www.t-live.co.uk

Thursday 7 August, 1- 3pm approx, Tour of Telford Town Park's pools, booking required.

Friday 22 August, 1 - 3pm approx, Heathland Tour, booking required.

Monday 28 July to Wednesday 27 August - range of activities on offer including, Butterfly Count Day, Mythical Story Walks, Nature Explorers Club sessions, Dragon and Damsel Fly walks, Bat Walk, Baby Ballet.

Friday 29 & Saturday 30 August, T-Live outdoor music event. Visit www.t-live.co.uk

Saturday 13 September, Official opening of the new Friend's Sensory Garden in the Chelsea Gardens. Event 12.30 - 2.30pm. Opening ceremony 1pm.

Please note any of the above activities may be subject to change.

For further details about any of the above activities and future events visit:

<http://www.telfordtownpark.co.uk>



25 July - 3 August Love Parks Week

Visit the Town Park website for details of what's on in the Park in support of this national week to celebrate our green spaces.



Keep up to date with the Friends of Telford Town Park

Visit our website www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Find us on Facebook <https://www.facebook.com/FOTTP>

Follow us on Twitter <https://twitter.com/FOTTP>

Call into the Park Visitor Centre or telephone 01952 - 382340

FOTTP, Telford Town Park Visitor Centre, Hinkshay Road, Telford, TF3 4EP

